

Chapter-9

The Preposition

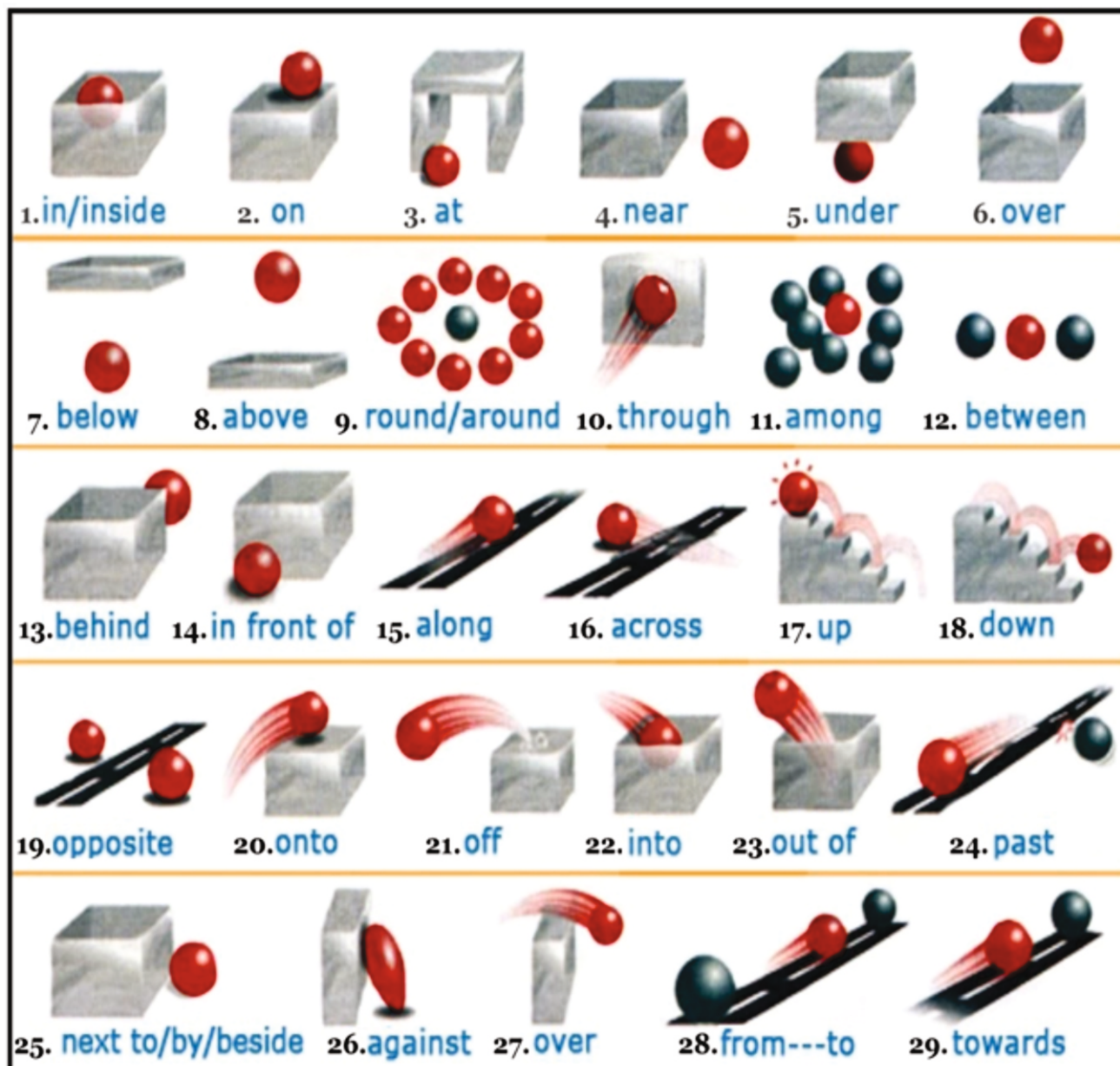
A preposition (pre-position), as the name suggests, is a word which is placed before a noun or a pronoun to establish the relation between the noun or pronoun and some other word in a sentence. Thus, a preposition is always followed by a noun or a pronoun.

Types of Preposition

1. Simple Preposition: in, of, on, up, with, for, at, out, off, by etc.
2. Compound Prepositions: without, within, outside, inside, into, etc.
3. Double Prepositions: Outside of, out of, from out, from behind, from beneath etc.
4. Participle Prepositions: Notwithstanding, concerning, regarding, considering, etc.
5. Phrase Prepositions: By means of, by virtue of, on account of, in opposition to, with regard to, for the sake of, instead of, on behalf of etc.

Prepositions of Place and Direction

Look at the pictures given below carefully to understand how prepositions can be used to indicate the relation of place or direction.



Prepositions of Place or Direction

1. The place may be seen as a point or place that can be identified.

Examples:

- ♦ He went to market.
- ♦ They waited at the main gate.
- ♦ I remained away from home for many years.

2. The place may be seen as a line.

- ♦ The train moved on the track.
- ♦ The ship was anchored a mile off the coast.
- ♦ He went across the road.
- ♦ They walked up/down the lane.
- ♦ They walked along the sea shore.

3. The place may be seen as a surface.

- ♦ They sat on the desk.
- ♦ They sat at the first desk.
- ♦ They went across the field.
- ♦ The apple fell on (to) the ground.

4. The place may be seen as an area which has boundaries and limits

- ♦ The farmer is in the field.
- ♦ She went through the forest.
- ♦ The thief ran into the street.
- ♦ We stayed out of the country.
- ♦ The children are playing in the park.

5. The place may be seen as a volume.

- ♦ He went into the room.
- ♦ Keep these books in the box.
- ♦ They went out of the house.
- ♦ The breeze blew through the trees.

6. Prepositions of Relative Position:

(a) Above, over, on top of, below, under, underneath and beneath show the relative position of two objects vertically.

(b) Before, in front of, behind, by, beside and after show the relative position of two objects horizontally.

Examples:

- ♦ The boy stood under the tree.
- ♦ He kept the letter under the pillow. (not below the pillow)
- ♦ I feel as if I were on top of the world.
- ♦ There is a temple in front of my house.
- ♦ The little child hid behind a tree.
- ♦ There is a bridge above/over the river.
- ♦ A river flows below the bridge.

Use of at/on/in

At is used for a point. On is used for a surface. In is used for an enclosed space.

At	In	On
at the bus stop	in the garden	on the wall
at the main gate	in mumbai	on the table
at door	in india	on the door
at the last table	in a box	on the cover
at top of the page	in my pocket	on the floor
at the end of the road	in my wallet	on the carpet
at the entrance	in her bag	on the menu
at the crossroads	in a car	on a page

Prepositions of Time

Time has two dimensions: Point of time and Period of time

Use of at

- ✧ For point of time, chiefly clock time: at 6 o' clock, at noon, at night, at midnight
- ✧ For holiday periods: at Christmas, at the weekend,
- ✧ For time phrase: at that time, at night, at an early stage, at an early date etc.

Use of on/in

- ✧ 'On' is used for days and dates: on Saturday, on November 25, 2017
- ✧ 'In' is used with the names of month, year, morning, evening and afternoon: in July, in 1985, in the morning, in the afternoon, in the evening

Use of for, from.....to/till, during

'For' is used to denote a period of time, 'from.....to/till' is used to denote a beginning point of time and a finishing point of time, 'during' is used to denote all through a period of time.

- ✧ I lived in Delhi for two years.
- ✧ I worked there from February to/till October.
- ✧ He learnt skating during summer vacation.

Use of before, after, since, till/until

These prepositions are used with point of time.

- ✧ We shall return before/after evening/ 5 0' clock/ July.
- ✧ He was born before/after 1985.
- ✧ She has been studying since morning.
- ✧ We waited till/until evening/7:30. (We did not wait after that time.)

Note: 'Till' is more informal than 'until'. In the beginning of a sentence 'until' is used.

Use of between, by, up to

'Between' is used to denote a starting point of time and a finishing point of time. 'By' is used to denote a point of time, 'up to' is also used to denote a point of time.

- ✧ The shop remains closed between 2 pm and 4pm.
- ✧ He will finish his work up to next week.
- ✧ They had completed their homework by 6 o'clock.

Use of through, throughout, towards, behind, to, past

- ✧ The day became cold towards evening. (preposition of time)
- ✧ The army headed towards the border. (preposition of place)
- ✧ Hurry up! We are behind time/schedule. (late)
- ✧ What is the time? It is ten minutes to two. It is ten minutes past two.
- ✧ It was past midnight when we reached home.

- ✧ The patient will not live through night.
- ✧ The museum is open daily throughout the year.

Prepositions of Instruments, Agent, Means by/with

‘By’ usually denotes the agent or doer; ‘with’ denotes the instrument.

- ✧ The apple was cut by Riya with a knife.
- ✧ The accident was seen by him with his own eyes.

‘By’ is also used to signify ‘by means of’.

- ✧ They usually travel by a car.

Prepositions of Manner

- ✧ She danced with a lot of grace.
- ✧ They played with confidence.

Prepositions of Cause, Reason, Purpose

- ✧ I bought this book for you.
- ✧ You should fight for your rights.
- ✧ He died of cancer.
- ✧ She is suffering from typhoid.
- ✧ She failed due to her carelessness.

Prepositions of Direction

Prepositions of direction denote direction or movement of persons or things with respect to someone or something else. Examples: to, towards, into, at, for, against, off, around, along, across, up, down etc.

- ✧ He went to market.
- ✧ He jumped into the well.
- ✧ He has taken the flight for Delhi.
- ✧ The army marched towards the line of control.
- ✧ Look at the sun.
- ✧ He leaned against the wall.

Prepositions of Possession

- ✧ Don't pull the tail of the dog.
- ✧ There is a man with a sword in his hands.

Prepositions of Measure, Rate

- ✧ Cloth is sold by the metre.
- ✧ He drove his car at 100 kmph.
- ✧ Bananas are available at 45 rupees per dozen.
- ✧ I bought this book for rupees 250.

Prepositions of Contrast, Concession

- ✧ With all his faults, he was accepted by his family.
- ✧ For all the wrong you have done to her, she loves you.

beneath / beyond

‘Beneath’ is used:

- ✧ To denote a position lower than somebody or something
They found the treasure beneath the roots of a big tree.

‘Beyond’ is used:

- ✧ To denote on or to the further side of something: The ball went beyond the boundary.
- ✧ Later than a particular time:
I will work on a new project for next six months, but I have not thought what I will do beyond that.

The Same Preposition with Many Uses

At/In

At is used:

- ♦ Before towns and villages: They live at Sangaria.
- ♦ For smaller place when two places are mentioned in a sentence:
He lives at Ferozepur in Punjab.
- ♦ For big towns or cities to denote a temporary stay
We stopped at Bathinda on the way to Ahmedabad from Jammu.
- ♦ To indicate a point in space: He is waiting for you at the main gate.
- ♦ With the name of building with reference to the activities going on inside
I work at a bank.
- ♦ To indicate direction: Look at the board.
- ♦ To indicate distance away from something: Can you read the board at 15 feet?
- ♦ To indicate a rate, price, speed etc: He ran at a full speed.
- ♦ To indicate order or frequency: She visited her doctor at regular intervals.
- ♦ To denote cause: She was delighted at the thought of winning the lottery.
- ♦ After certain adjectives: He is good at painting.
- ♦ With the name of a person+'s to refer to that person's home or place of work
There is a party at Verma's today.
- ♦ For point of time, chiefly clock time: at 6 o' clock, at noon, at night, at midnight
- ♦ For holiday periods: at Christmas, at the weekend,
- ♦ For time phrase: at that time, at night, at an early stage, at an early date etc.

In is used:

- ♦ Before cities, countries and provinces: He lives in India.
- ♦ To indicate a place at a point within the area or volume of something
Nile is the longest river in the world.
- ♦ To indicate a place within the shape of something
He had a ball in his hand. He is still in bed.
- ♦ To indicate a movement: They went out in the street.
- ♦ To indicate a period of time: I was born in November 1978
- ♦ In the sense of after (a maximum length of time): They will return in two hours.
- ♦ In the sense of during/for generally after a negative or first, last etc.
I never met him in these four years.
- ♦ To form the whole or part: There are seven days in a week.
- ♦ In the sense of wearing clothes: There was a man in suit,
- ♦ To indicate physical surroundings
Let's sit in the sun. Don't go out in the rain.
- ♦ To indicate form, shapes, arrangements or quantities
Stand in a row. Work in groups.
- ♦ To indicate the medium, means, material
She talks in Telugu. The letter was written in black ink.
- ♦ To indicate the state or condition of somebody or something
She is in deep depression. We left the room in a hurry.
- ♦ To refer to something
He is blind in one eye. Carrots are rich in fibre.
- ♦ To introduce a particular person: She found her soul mate in him.
- ♦ To indicate occupation or activity: His father is in politics.

In/Into

- ♦ In denotes rest or position inside something: She sat in an armchair.
- ♦ Into denotes motion or direction, change or transformation
He jumped into the river. Translate this passage into English.

To/into

- ♦ To denotes direction whereas into denotes entry from outside.
They went to market. He went into the room.

In/Within/Before

- ♦ In denotes at the end of a period of time
They will return your books in one week. (after the expiry of the period of one week)
- ♦ Within denotes before the expiry of the specified period of time
They will return your books within one week. (before the expiry of the period of one week)
- ♦ Within is also used to denote the boundaries of a place or limits of something
Students must remain within the campus during school hours.
- ♦ Before is used when we specify some time before a point of time/fixed time
They will return before 30th November.

On/upon

On is used:

- ♦ To denote a position covering, touching or forming part of a surface
The cat is on the table. There is a painting on the wall.
- ♦ To denote supported by or attached to:
She hung her coat on a peg. The flag was hoisted on a high pole.
- ♦ With days and dates
I will come back on Sunday. My birthday falls on September 15.
- ♦ To denote a point of time or occasion
I congratulated her on getting the first rank in the board examination.
- ♦ To denote concerning or regarding: He has written many books on psychology.
- ♦ To indicate membership of a group or organisation:
He was on the selection committee.
- ♦ To denote regular consumption of something
A cow lives on grass. Most cars run on petrol.
- ♦ To denote direction
You will find the library on your left.
- ♦ To indicate near or close to a place. The city was on the bank of a river.
- ♦ To indicate a basis, ground or reason for something
He was dismissed from the job on the charge of corruption.
On her advice, I changed my decision.
- ♦ To denote financial support: She lived on the little money sent by her brother.
- ♦ To denote by means of, using: Her speech was telecast on television.
- ♦ To indicate an activity, a purpose or a state
He went abroad on a business tour. They took some money on loan.

Upon is used:

- ♦ To denote things in motion
The cat jumped upon the table. The lion pounced upon the deer.

Above/Over

Above is used:

- ♦ To denote higher than
The water has risen above the mark of danger. We flew above the clouds.
- ♦ To denote higher in rank, position, importance etc. than
A Principal ranks above a lecturer.
- ♦ To denote greater in number, price, weight etc than:
The temperature is above normal today.
- ♦ To denote more than:
He values money above relationships.
- ♦ To denote that someone or something is too good or great or beyond the reach of something:
His subordinate is above suspicion.

Over is used:

- ♦ To denote resting on the surface of and partly or completely covering
She put a blanket over her ailing mother. Spread a cover over the table.
- ♦ To denote a higher position than something but not touching
He held an umbrella over his head. There was a fan over my head.
- ♦ To denote crossing from one side of something to the other; across
She looked over the window. The children ran over the carpet.
- ♦ To denote that someone or something moves to the other side
He jumped over the wall. She went over the stream.
- ♦ To denote on the far or opposite side of something
Whose house is that over the street?
- ♦ To denote in or across every part or most parts of some place
It is raining over the mountains. He is famous all over the world.
- ♦ To denote more than:
He is over forty.
- ♦ To indicate command, authority, superiority or control
The British ruled over India for 200 years.
- ♦ To denote throughout or during:
They discussed the issue over dinner.
- ♦ To denote because of, concerning:
There is a dispute between them over a piece of land.
- ♦ To denote transmitted by:
They informed about the accident over telephone.

Below/Under/Beneath/Beyond

Below is used:

- ♦ To denote at or to a lower position, level etc.
The water in the river is below the mark of danger.
Her dress is below the knees.

Under is used:

- ♦ To denote in, to or through a position directly below something
The cat is under the chair. There is a river under the bridge.
- ♦ To denote covered by; below the surface of
He kept the letter under the pillow. The children hid their faces under the blanket.
- ♦ To denote in or to a position next to and lower than something
They refreshed themselves under the waterfall.
- ♦ To denote younger than a specified age
Nobody under 18 is allowed to buy alcohol.
- ♦ To denote being in a state of
The bridge is under construction. Your proposal is under consideration.

- ♦ To denote less than
Her monthly income was under ten thousand rupees.
- ♦ To denote who or what controls, governs or manages somebody or something
The country is under the martial law. She has 50 workers under her.
- ♦ According to an agreement, a law or system
A man was detained under the Arms Act.
- ♦ To denote being affected by
The building collapsed under stress. She has been under stress lately.

Beneath is used

- ♦ To denote a position lower than somebody or something
They found the treasure beneath the roots of a big tree.
- ♦ Not good enough for somebody
He considers such jobs beneath him.

Beyond is used

- ♦ To denote on or to the further side of something
The road went beyond the village up to the hills.
- ♦ Later than a particular time: The rain will continue beyond evening.
- ♦ More than something: Our achievement was far beyond what we had expected.
- ♦ Used to say that something is not possible: His behaviour is beyond improvement.
- ♦ To far or too advanced for somebody or something
The sums were beyond the understanding of the students.

Since/From

Since is used

- ♦ To denote from a specified time in the past till a later past time, or till now
I have not seen him since November.

From is used

- ♦ To indicate the place or direction from which some person or something starts
He went from Delhi to Mumbai.
- ♦ To indicate the time at which something starts
They lived in London from 2008 to 2012.
- ♦ To indicate who gave, sent or communicated something
They received a message from the Head Office.
- ♦ To indicate where some person or thing originates, or is stored
This is a famous quotation from Keats.
- ♦ To indicate distance between two places
Her village is ten kilometres from the town.
- ♦ To indicate the range of something
He meets from 15 to 20 people every day. The prices of these trousers start from 150 rupees.
- ♦ To indicate the state or form of something before a change
Translate this letter from English to Hindi.
- ♦ To indicate the material from which something is made
Ghee is made from butter.
- ♦ To indicate separation, removal etc.
The leaves fall from trees in autumn. Somebody has stolen money from my bag.
- ♦ To indicate protection or prevention
He stopped me from entering the office. They saved a woman from drowning.
- ♦ To indicate cause or reason, cause or motive
She fell sick from overwork. They helped us from a sense of compassion.
- ♦ To make distinction between two persons or thing
How will you distinguish salt from sugar? My brother is different from me.

With/by

With is used:

- ♦ To denote in the company of or presence of, to denote in the charge or possession of
I go to school with my brother. She leaves her son with her mother every day.
- ♦ To denote having or carrying:
I saw a lady with a black bag in her hand.
- ♦ To indicate a tool or instrument used
Cut the apple with a knife. I saw it with my own eyes.
- ♦ To indicate the material or item used:
The bag was filled with coins.
- ♦ To denote agreement or support
She was with the team on this point. This hair style goes well with your dress.
- ♦ To denote because of, on account of:
He was pale with anaemia.
- ♦ To indicate the manner, circumstances or condition in which something is done or takes place
You must do your work with the whole heart. They welcomed us with open arms.
- ♦ Employed by or using the services of
I bank with OBC bank. She worked with an insurance company for two years.
- ♦ To indicate separation from
I cannot part with my family. They dispensed with the formalities.
- ♦ To denote in spite of; despite:
With all her faults, he still respected her.

By is used:

- ♦ To denote near, beside, at the side of
They have a house by the river. Come and sit by me.
- ♦ To denote agent or doer in a passive sentence
He was praised by the teacher. Othello is a tragedy written by William Shakespeare.
- ♦ To denote across, along, passing through
The thieves entered by the back window.
They travelled to Kerala by Maharashtra and Karnataka.
- ♦ Pass: He walked by me without noticing me.
- ♦ To denote not later than; before
You must submit the report by Saturday. I shall be in Delhi by 5 o' clock.
- ♦ To denote during: He sleeps by day and works by night.
- ♦ To denote through the means of:
Can I pay by cheque? They contacted me by email.
- ♦ To denote as a result of, because of
He met her by chance. She forgot the papers at home by mistake.
- ♦ To indicate a means of transport or a route taken: I usually travel by bus.
- ♦ To indicate a part of the body, or an item of clothing touched, held etc.
The policeman took the thief by the collar.
- ♦ To denote using a standard or unit of measurement: Oranges are sold by the dozen.
- ♦ To denote in successive units, groups or degrees of: He is getting weak day by day.
- ♦ To denote according to; from the evidence of: What is the time by your watch?

Between/among

Between is used:

- ♦ To denote shared by two persons or thing
There is a table between the two chairs.
The property was divided between two brothers.

Among is used:

- ♦ To indicate division, distribution, possession, or joint activity of, for or by more than two persons
The property was divided among four sisters.
- ♦ To indicate connection, association, inclusion
He was among the first few persons to enter the hall. We saw him among the crowd.

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Beside/besides

Beside is used:

- ♦ To mean at, or by, the side of; next to
There is a small park beside my house. He sat beside me.
- ♦ To denote compared with
He was quite short beside his brother.
Beside your earlier movie, this one seems more well-directed.

Besides is used:

- ♦ To denote except; apart from: No one helped with him besides his friend.
- ♦ To denote in addition to
Besides a gold medal, he was given a cash prize of rupees five thousand.

Of/off

Of is used

- ♦ To denote belonging to: India is a land of fairs and festivals.
- ♦ To denote originating from or living in: He comes of a noble family.
- ♦ To denote in relation to, concerning or depicting: I need a map of India.
- ♦ To denote about: He had never heard of such places before.
- ♦ To denote the material used to make something: She wore a beautiful dress of silk.
- ♦ To denote so that somebody no longer has, suffers from something
The robbers robbed us of the money we had. Can you cure her of depression?
- ♦ To indicate a cause: She died of cancer.
- ♦ To introduce a phrase that describes a preceding Noun
He is a man of few words. She is a lady of virtue.
- ♦ To show who is being described by It is/was+ Adjective
It is very kind of you to help me.

Off is used

- ♦ To denote down or away from: He fell off the tree.
- ♦ To denote accessible from: There is a lane off the main road.
- ♦ To denote at some distance from: There is a good restaurant off my house.
- ♦ To denote not wishing or needing to take: She remained off food for a week.

For

For is used:

- ♦ To indicate the person intended to receive or benefit from
My father bought a new watch for me.
- ♦ To indicate purpose or function
They went for a picnic. He looked for his book everywhere.

- ♦ To indicate destination, aim or reason: He has taken the flight for Delhi.
- ♦ To denote as the price, reward or penalty of something
He got Nobel Prize for his contribution to world literature.
I bought this book for five hundred rupees. One has to pay for one's sins.
- ♦ To denote as the replacement of something else.
He got two thousand rupees for his old watch.
- ♦ To denote as a representative of: He spoke for all the workers in the factory.
- ♦ Employed by: She works for a private company.
- ♦ In support of somebody or something: Are you for or against the proposal?
- ♦ To denote in order to obtain: He came to me for discussion over a case.
- ♦ To denote a length of time/period of time:
He has been playing for two hours. I will stay here for a week.
- ♦ To denote as the equivalent of, in return for
You will always find a saint for a rogue.
- ♦ To denote with regard to; concerning
He was anxious for his result. They are eager for us to join them.
- ♦ To show a reason, cause, because of, on account of
For God's sake, don't disturb me. Please take care of yourself for your family's sake.
The city is famous for its historical monuments.
- ♦ To indicate that something is intended to happen at the specified time
The doctor has given me an appointment for 2nd December.
They got a reservation for the first week of June.
- ♦ To indicate the occasion when something happens
This is for the first time that he has visited this city.
It was for the last time that they were meeting.
- ♦ To indicate a distance: They walked for ten miles to reach the city.
- ♦ To show purpose or design: This presentation is for you to prepare.
It is for you to decide what you want to do in life.

Use of Behind/In Front of

Behind is used

- ♦ To denote at or towards the back of somebody or something, and often hidden by it or them:
There is a small temple behind my house.
- ♦ To denote less progress than somebody or something
Hurry up! We are behind schedule.
- ♦ To denote support or approval
Whatever she did, her family always stood up behind her
- ♦ To denote responsibility for starting or developing something
He was the man behind starting this new project.
- ♦ Used to denote that something is in somebody's past
Our Principal has a long experience behind her.

In Front of is used

- ♦ To denote the position of somebody or something before someone or something. It means the same as outside but not opposite
He parked the car in front of my house.
- ♦ To denote that something is done in someone's presence
Please don't use such language in front of children.
- ♦ Used to denote time which is yet to come; not yet passed
Don't give up in the face of adversity. You have your whole life in front of you.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with 'at', 'in', 'to' or 'into'.

1. He livesFerozepurPunjab.
2. He is waiting for youthe main gate.
3. Look the board.
4. He ran a full speed.
5. We left the rooma hurry.
6. He is blindone eye.
7. Carrots are rich fibre.
8. He jumpedthe river.
9. Translate this passageEnglish.
10. They wentmarket.
11. He is goodpainting.
12. Nile is the longest river the world.
13. He parked the carthe street.
14. Keep your books your bags.
15. Let's sit the sun.
16. She talksTelugu.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with 'in', 'within', 'on', 'upon'

1. They will return your books one week. (after the expiry of the period of one week)
2. They will return your booksone week. (before the expiry of the period of one week)
3. Students must remain the campus during school hours.
4. The cat is the table.
5. The cat jumped the table.
6. There is a paintingthe wall.
7. I will come back Sunday.
8. You will find the libraryyour left.
9. Her speech was telecast television.
10. The lion pounced the deer.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with 'above', 'over', 'below', 'under'

1. The water has risenthe mark of danger.
2. A Principal ranksa lecturer.
3. She put a blankether ailing mother.
4. He held an umbrellahis head.
5. They built a bridgethe river.

6. He jumped the wall.
7. It is raining the mountains.
8. He is famous all the world.
9. The British ruled India for 200 years.
10. They discussed the issue dinner.
11. There is a dispute between them a piece of land.
12. The water in the river is the mark of danger.
13. Write this line.
14. The temperature is 17 degree today, so it is cold.
15. There is a river the bridge.
16. The tired boy sat a tree.
17. He kept the letter the pillow.
18. The children hid their faces the blanket.
19. Your proposal is consideration.
20. She has 50 workers her.

Fill in the blanks with 'between' or 'among'

1. There is a table the two chairs.
2. Both the professors wrote this paper on 'Health Education' them.
3. The property was divided four sisters.
4. He was the first few persons to enter the hall.
5. We saw him the crowd.
6. Ludhiana is the most crowded cities in the Punjab.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with 'since or 'for'.

1. I have not seen him November.
2. She has not eaten anything morning.
3. Children have been playing two hours.
4. We stayed at Delhi a week.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with 'from', 'with', 'by',

1. He went Delhi to Mumbai.
2. They lived in London 2008 to 2012.
3. He is Bangalore.
4. Her village is ten kilometres the town.
5. Translate this letter English to Hindi.
6. The leaves fall trees in autumn.
7. I cannot part my family.
8. They have a house the river.

9. Come and sit me.
10. He was praised the teacher.
11. He borrowed some money his friend.
12. There is a man a long beard.
13. Cut the apple a knife.
14. The bag was filled coins.
15. She was angry me.
16. My brother is different me.
17. I go to school my brother.
18. They fought their neighbours.
19. She was trembling cold.
20. They welcomed us open arms.
21. I can't buy a house such a small amount.
22. I usually travel bus.
23. Cloth is sold the metre.
24. What is the time your watch?

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with 'of', 'off' or 'for'.

1. India is a land fairs and festivals.
2. He comes a noble family.
3. He fell the tree.
4. She works a private company.
5. He has been playing two hours.
6. Please get a cup tea me.
7. He told me his experience at Italy.
8. My father bought a new watch me.
9. They went a picnic.
10. He is wearing a chain gold.
11. Take a book the shelf.
12. Write the names of days the week.
13. She died cancer.
14. The doctor has given me an appointment 2nd December.

15. There is a lanethe main road.
16. She remained food for a week.
17. He got Nobel Prize his contribution to world literature.
18. God's sake, don't disturb me.
19. The city is famous its historical monuments.
20. They walked ten miles to reach the city.

Words Followed by Appropriate Prepositions

1. Abide by: The students must abide by the rules of the school.
2. Absorb in: He was absorbed in his work.
3. Accused of: The convict was accused of murder.
4. Acquainted with: Are you acquainted with your new neighbour?
5. Addicted to: He is addicted to drugs.
6. Admit to: The injured were admitted to the hospital.
7. Afraid of: He is not afraid of death.
8. Agree to: He agreed to this proposal.
9. Agree with: He agreed with me.
10. Aim at: What are you aiming at?
11. Angry with: Are you angry with me?
12. Apologise to, for: I apologised to the teacher for my misconduct.
13. Ashamed of: You must be ashamed of your behaviour.
14. Attend to: Attend to your lessons.
15. Aware of: You must be aware of your responsibilities.
16. Belong to: He belongs to a rich family.
17. Bless with: He is blessed with two sons.
18. Blind in/of: This man is blind in/of one eye.
19. Blind to: Don't be blind to your shortcomings.
20. Born in: He was born in a rich family.
21. Bring up: He was brought up by his aunt.
22. Care of: Take care of your health.
23. Compete with: Can you compete with him?
24. Complain to, against: The teacher complained against the naughty students to the Principal.
25. Congratulate on: She congratulated me on my success.
26. Consist of: His family consists of his parents and two siblings.
27. Deal in: His father deals in gold and silver.
28. Die of (disease): He died of heart attack.
29. Differ from (thing): My dress differs from yours.
30. Differ on (point): I differ with you on this point.
31. Differ with (person): I differ with you on this point.
32. Disgusted at, with: I was disgusted with him at his misbehaviour.
33. Dismiss from: The boss dismissed him from job.

34. Displeased at: He was displeased at your misconduct.
35. Displeased with: He was displeased with you.
36. Due to: He achieved success due to his hard work.
37. Eager for: He is eager for praise.
38. Eligible for: He was not eligible for the post.
39. Engage in: She is engaged in shopping for her wedding.
40. Engage to: He got engaged to a doctor.
41. Equal to: Two multiplied by two is equal to four.
42. Expert in (doing): He is expert in repairing air conditions.
43. Expert at (thing): He is expert at drawing.
44. Exempt from: Kindly exempt the poor students from paying the school fee.
45. Explain to: He explained the matter to me.
46. Export to: Chinese toys are exported to many countries in the world.
47. Faith in: I have a deep faith in God.
48. Faithful to: The servant is faithful to his master.
49. False to: Never be false to your friends.
50. Familiar to: Her face is familiar to mine.
51. Familiar with: I am familiar with him.
52. Famous for: Jalandhar is famous for sports goods.
53. Fight for: He fought for the honour of his country.
54. Fight with: You should not fight with your friends.
55. Fill with: Fill in the blanks with Prepositions.
56. Fit for: He is fit for this job.
57. Fond of: I am fond of listening to classical music.
58. Free from: He is free from all the worries now.
59. Full of: The jug was full of water.
60. Gifted with: She is gifted with a sweet voice.
61. Good at: He is good at painting.
62. Grateful to: I will always be grateful to you.
63. Greedy for: Don't be greedy for money.
64. Grieve at: He grieved at his failure.
65. Honest with: She has always been honest with me.
66. Hope of: There is no hope of the patient's survival.
67. Import from: We import machines from China.
68. Inferior to: Your dress is inferior to mine.
69. Inform of: I informed him of my arrival.
70. Injurious to: Smoking is injurious to health.
71. Inquire into (a matter): A committee was appointed to inquire into the allegations.
72. Interest in: He has no interest in studies.
73. Interfere with: Don't interfere with my work.
74. Introduce to: I introduced my friend to my parents.
75. Invite to: We invited them to lunch.

76. Jealous of: We should not be jealous of others.
77. Junior to: He is junior to me.
78. Kind to: We should be kind to animals.
79. Knock at: Someone is knocking at the door.
80. Known to: He is known to everybody.
81. Key to: Hard work is the key to success.
82. Laugh at: Children laughed at the beggar.
83. Listen to: Please listen to me.
84. Loyal to: One must be loyal to one's country.
85. Mad with: The boss was mad with anger.
86. Made of: These chairs are made of wood.
87. Married to: She got married to a businessman.
88. Need of: He is in need of money.
89. Need for: There is a great need for qualified and trained teachers.
90. Obligated to: I am obliged to you for your help.
91. Open to: We should be open to suggestions for improvement.
92. Opposite to: My house is opposite to the railway station.
93. Pleased with: My teachers are pleased with my performance.
94. Polite to: Be polite to all.
95. Pray to: I pray to God for your health.
96. Prepare for: The students are preparing for exams.
97. Pride in: She takes pride in her beauty.
98. Proud of: She is proud of her beauty.
99. Ready for: I am ready for the match.
100. Recover from: May you recover soon from illness!
101. Refer to: The term 'Arts' usually refers to 'Humanities and social sciences'.
102. Rely on: You can rely on me.
103. Reply to: He replied to all my letters.
104. Responsible for: Who is responsible for this mess?
105. Rid of: I want to get rid of my old car.
106. Satisfied with: The Director was satisfied with his acting.
107. Search for: The thirsty crow searched for water everywhere.
108. Search of: The thirsty crow was in search of water.
109. Shock at: The whole world was shocked at the terrorist attack in the USA.
110. Sorry for: I am sorry for the delay.
111. Stand by: My parents always stood by me through thick and thin.
112. Suffer from: I have been suffering from fever for two days.
113. Superior to: Your coat is superior to mine.
114. Surprised at: We were surprised at his misconduct.
115. Thankful to, for: I am thankful to you for your help.
116. Thinking of: The fox thought of a plan to get the piece of bread from the crow.
117. Tired of: I am tired of waiting for them.
118. True to: One must remain true to one's friends.
119. Useful for: This book is very useful for learning mathematics.
120. Wait for: He waited for me for two hours.

Exercise: Tick the correct preposition in the following sentences.

1. He cut the apple with/by a knife.
2. Who is knocking on/at the door?
3. What is the time in/by your watch?
4. My notebook was corrected with/by the teacher.
5. My brother and I distributed the oranges between/among us.
6. The cat is on/upon the table.
7. She jumped in/into the river.
8. It has been raining from/since morning.
9. He is sitting on/in the chair.
10. Riya is good in/at studies.
11. I saw a little puppy crying to/for help.
12. There is a problem in/with this laptop.
13. He waited for me on/at the main gate.
14. The dog jumped across/over the wall.
15. He swam around/across the river.
16. He died with/of heart attack.
17. I usually travel by/in a car.
18. Children have been playing since/for two hours.
19. Kindly leave your keys at/on the reception.
20. He works in/at a bank.
21. Will you sit besides/beside me for a while?
22. The thief entered the room from/through the window.
23. The earth revolves across/around the sun.
24. There is a bank in front of/opposite the sweet shop.
25. Kasauli is a small town between/among the Shivalik hills.
26. It is snowing on/over the valley.
27. Kindly put a blanket on/over the child.
28. Why are you angry with/at me?
29. You must remain of/off TV during your examination.
30. He has a deep faith in/on God.

Exercise: Underline the incorrect preposition in each sentence and write the correct one in the space provided.

1. She is blind with one eye.....
2. He comes from a noble family.
3. Hard work is the key of success.....
4. Look on the board.....
5. He is listening at music.
6. This table is made from wood.
7. She is proud with her beauty.
8. I am tired with waiting for their reply.....
9. My father deals with iron.....
10. Children laughed on the beggar.....
11. I need a cup off tea.....
12. They contacted me with e-mail.....
13. The students on the last bench made a lot of noise.....
14. He has 15 men working below him.....
15. Please switch of the fan.
16. There was a bridge on the river.....
17. The tiger ran in full speed.
18. This pen is available for 50 rupees
19. I bought this pen at 45 rupees.
20. He will finish his work since next week
21. They walked across the sea shore
22. The story turned serious to the end
23. He leaned with the wall.
24. He is in stress these days.
25. I am displeased with your behaviour

Practice Sheet

